

State of the Web 2020–2025

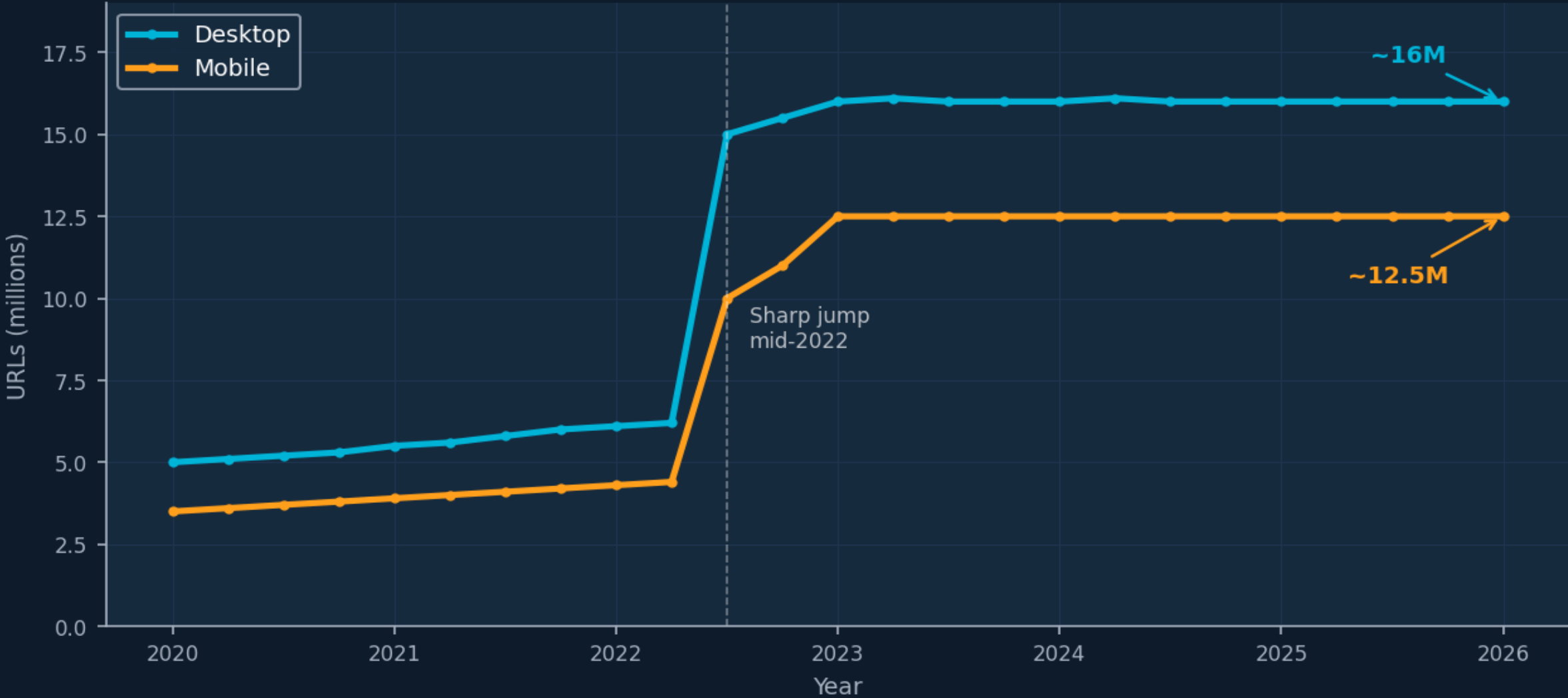
HTTP Archive Trends in Page Weight, Protocols & Security

Data source: HTTP Archive | Jan 2020 – Mar 2026

For web performance engineers & front-end architects

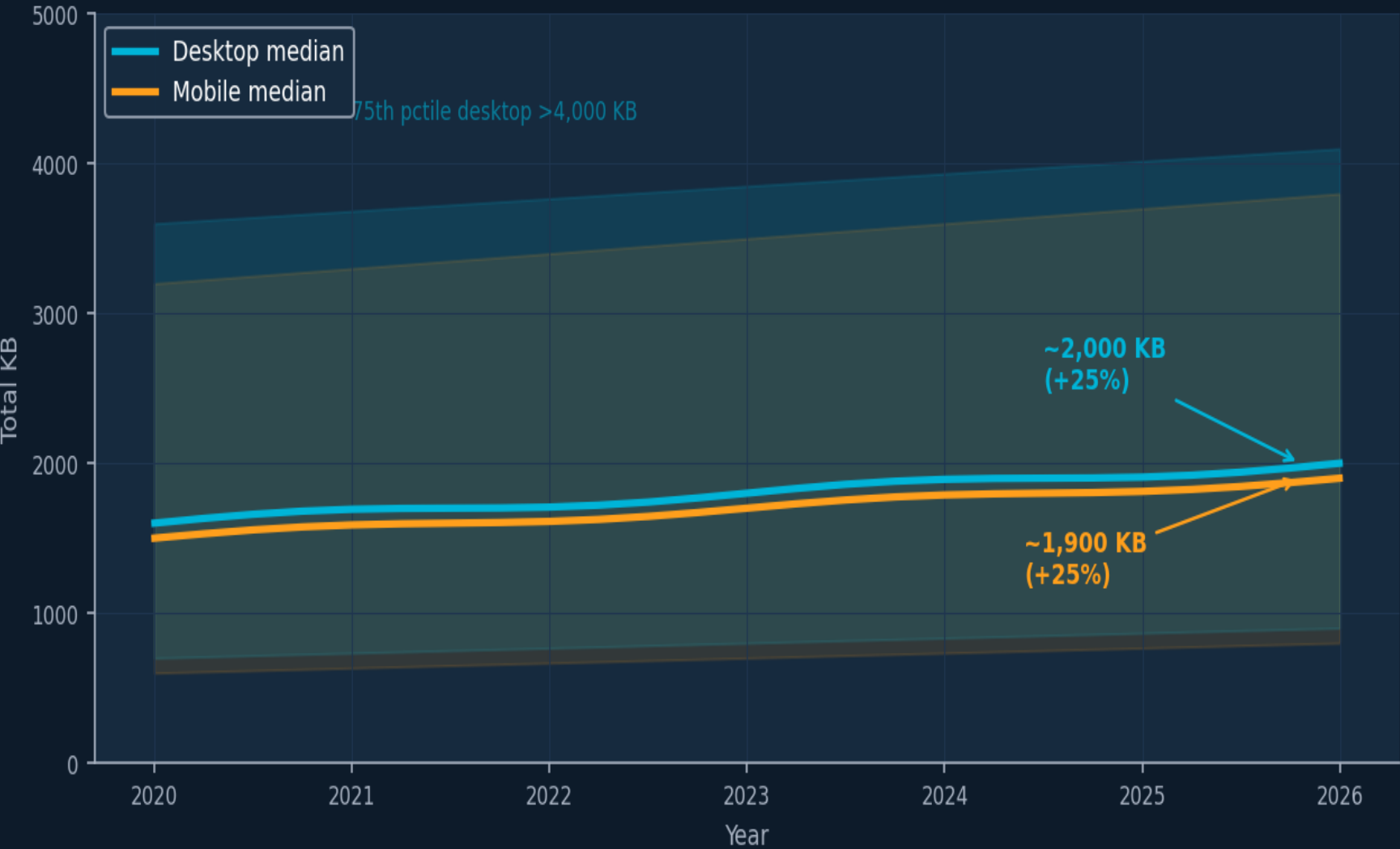
Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020

HTTP Archive desktop & mobile crawl counts, Jan 2020 – Mar 2026



Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop

Total transfer size (median, KB) with interquartile range — desktop vs. mobile



Desktop median

~2,000 KB

▲ 25%

Mobile median

~1,900 KB

▲ 25%

76 Requests per Desktop Page — TCP Connections Drop to 12

More requests, fewer connections — multiplexing efficiency gains from HTTP/2 & HTTP/3

REQUESTS / PAGE

76

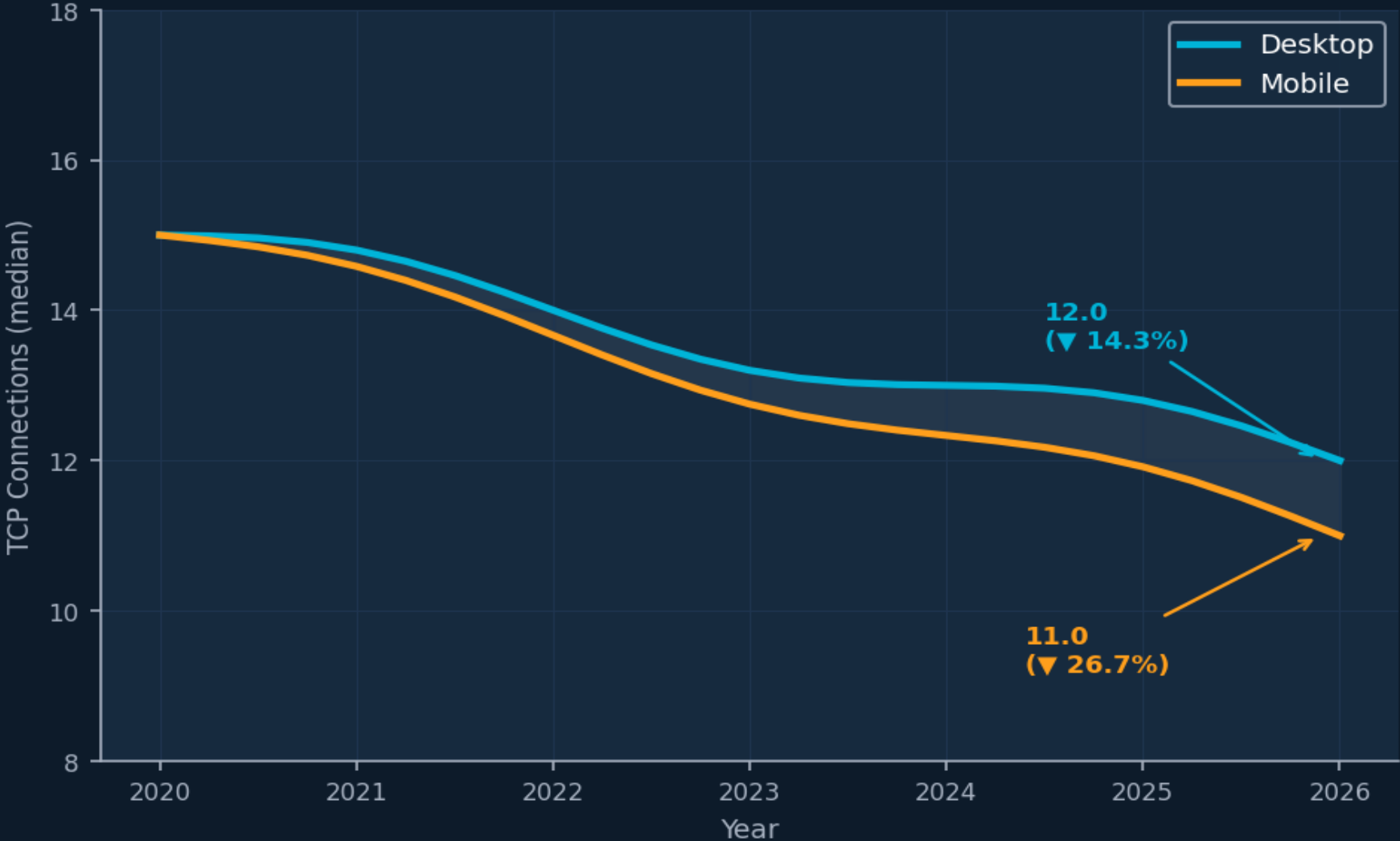
desktop (median) ▲ 2.7%

▲ 2.9% mobile (median: 71)

MULTIPLEXING EFFECT

HTTP/2 & HTTP/3 allow many requests over fewer connections, reducing latency and TCP overhead.

TCP Connections Per Page



HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

Share of HTTPS requests — desktop 99.2% | mobile 99.1% | up ~19–20 pp since 2020

HTTPS ADOPTION

99%+

of all web requests use HTTPS

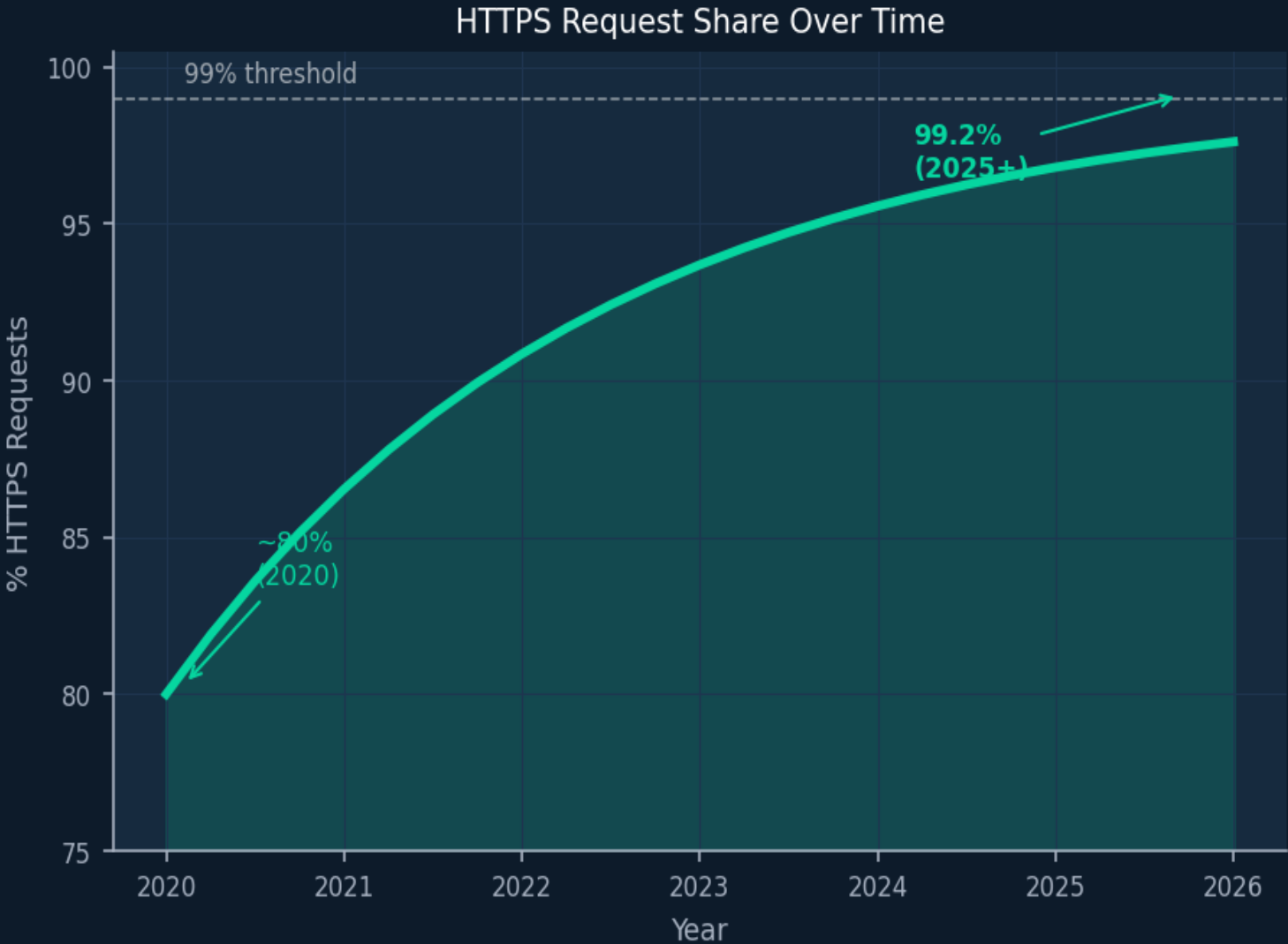
Desktop

99.2%

Mobile

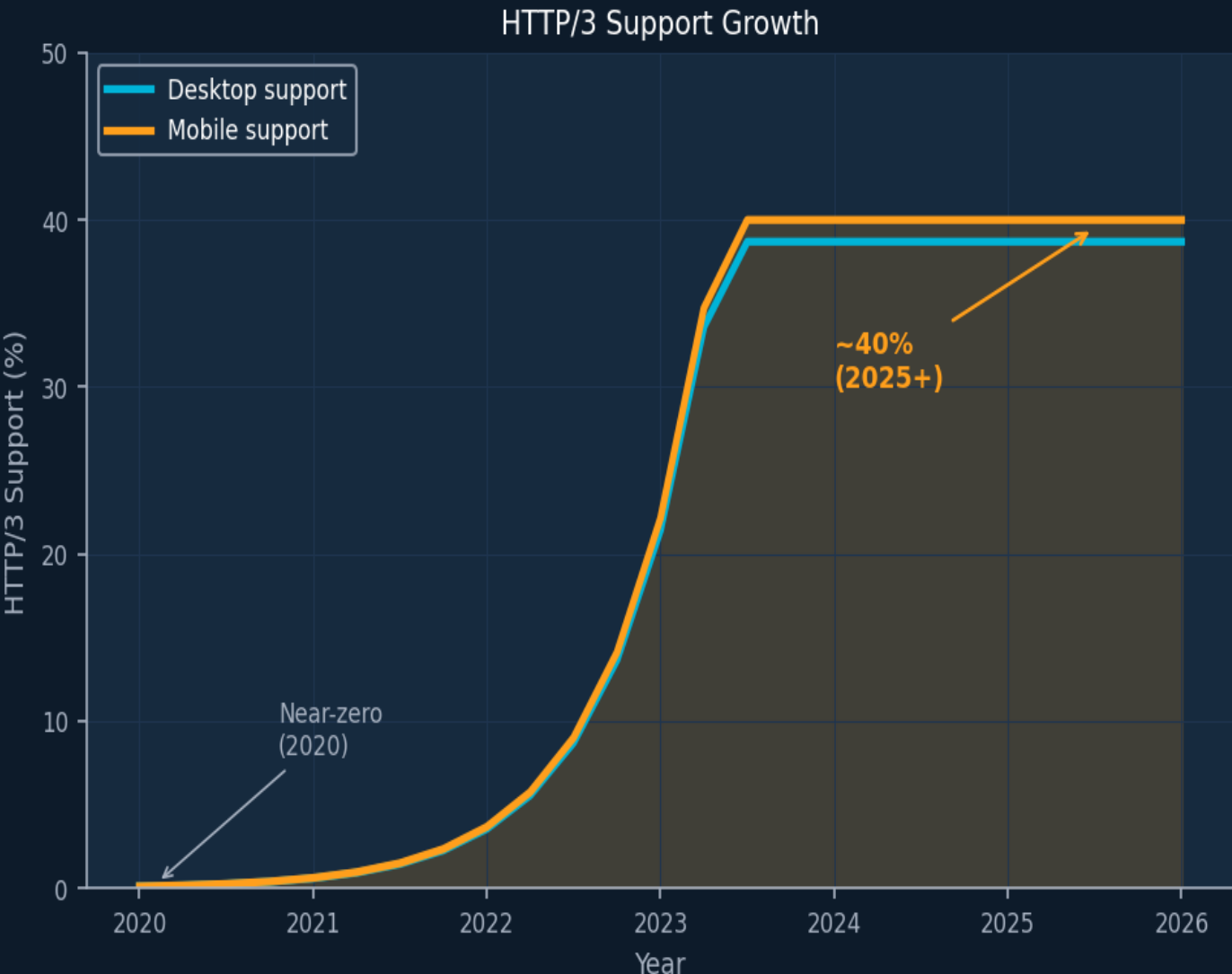
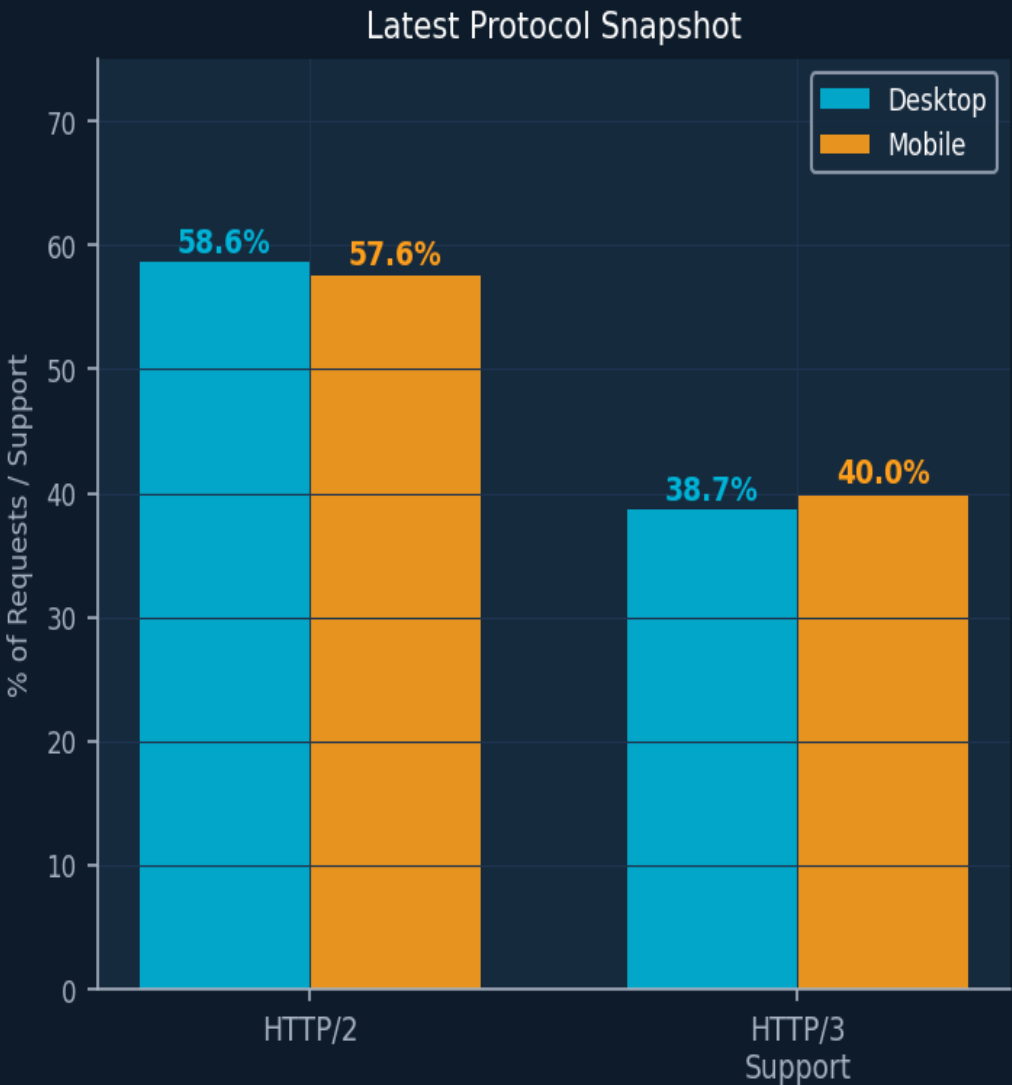
99.1%

Plaintext HTTP is effectively extinct on the modern web.



HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

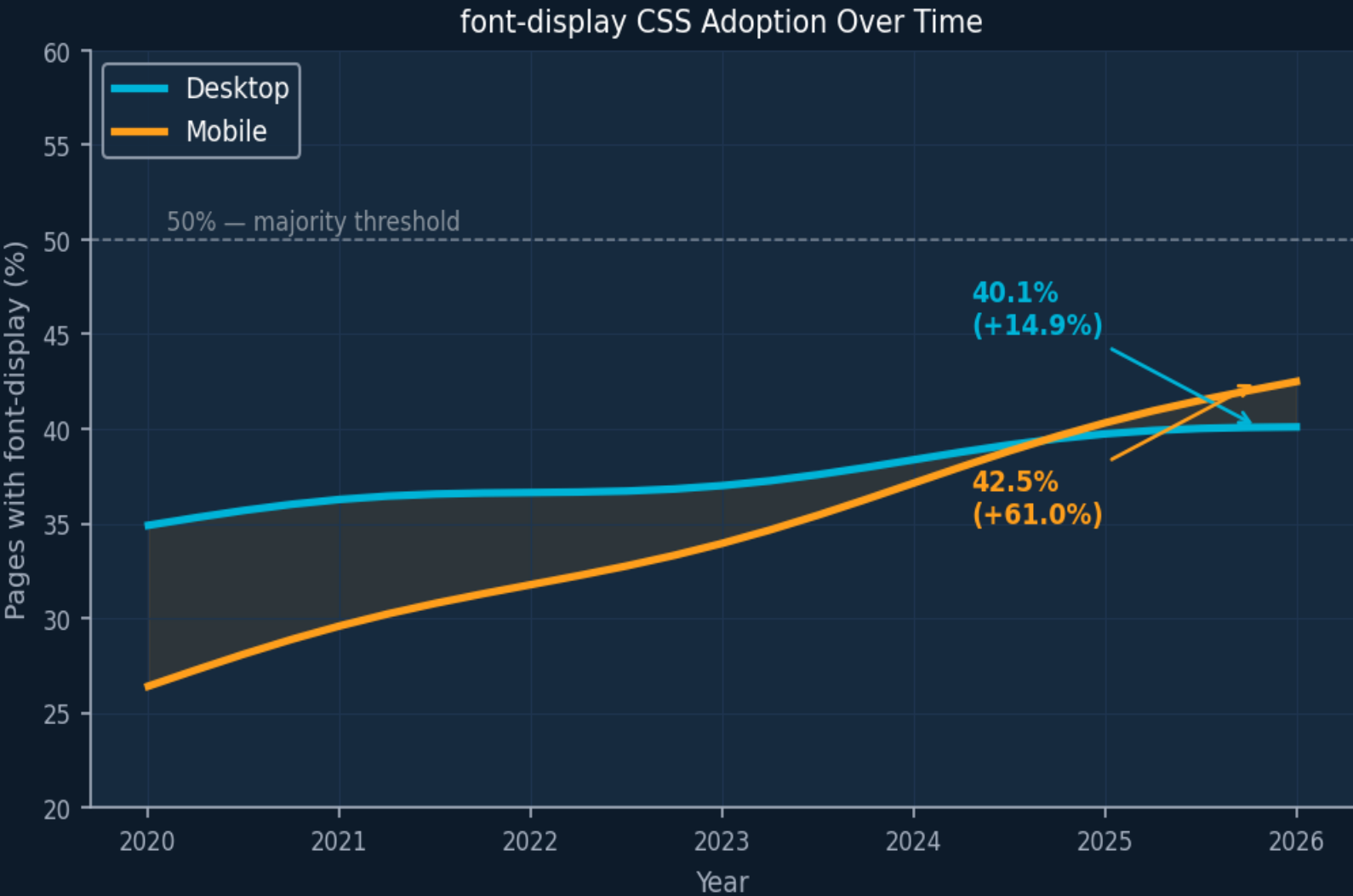
Protocol share snapshot (latest) + HTTP/3 growth trajectory | Note: HTTP/3 measured as server support, not actual usage



* HTTP Archive measures HTTP/3 server support (Alt-Svc), not actual usage — fresh Chrome connections default to HTTP/2.

font-display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020

Lighthouse-measured font-display CSS adoption — avoids Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT)



WHAT IS FOIT?

Flash of Invisible Text occurs when a browser hides text until a web font finishes loading.

font-display controls this behavior — e.g., swap renders fallback text immediately.

CURRENT ADOPTION

Desktop

40.1%

▲ 14.9%

Mobile

42.5%

▲ 61.0%

>57% of pages still risk FOIT

Key Takeaways: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

Page weight keeps climbing

Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB — ~25% heavier than 2020. Richer media & JavaScript continue to grow page size.

HTTPS is effectively universal

99.2% desktop / 99.1% mobile requests are encrypted. Plaintext HTTP is extinct on the modern web.

HTTP/3 is the fastest-growing protocol metric

From near-zero to ~40% server support in under 4 years — HTTP/3 is rapidly becoming mainstream.

Fewer TCP connections despite more requests

Multiplexing in HTTP/2 & HTTP/3 cut median connections per page by 14–27%, improving network efficiency.

font-display still underused

~40–42% adoption means >57% of pages still risk FOIT. Low-effort CSS property with significant UX impact.

CALL TO ACTION: Benchmark your site against these baselines — httparchive.org/reports/state-of-the-web